Experiment-14

Exploring Pro-Code Extension of a Zoho Creator Application Using Zoho Catalyst / Custom Functions

Aim:

To explore the pro-code capabilities of Zoho Creator by extending an application using Zoho Catalyst and custom functions, enabling additional business logic, automation, and integration with external services.

Theory:

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform used to build business applications using forms, reports, dashboards, and workflows. Pro-code extensions allow developers to enhance these applications using programming logic and backend services.

Zoho Catalyst is a serverless application development platform that provides backend capabilities such as functions, APIs, data storage, and application integration. It allows developers to implement custom backend logic and connect applications with other services.

Custom Functions in Zoho Creator allow developers to write reusable code using Deluge, Zoho's scripting language. These functions can be used to perform calculations, validate data, update records, automate tasks, and integrate with other applications.

The pro-code extension approach combines the ease of low-code development with the flexibility of programming. For example, in a Library Book Issue Management System, a custom function can validate due dates or update issue status, while a Catalyst function can provide additional backend processing or API-based integration when required.

Thus, pro-code extensions improve the flexibility, functionality, and automation capabilities of Zoho Creator applications.

Procedure:

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and open the existing application.
2. Examine the application's forms, reports, dashboards, and workflows.
3. Open the application settings or workflow section and locate the option for creating a custom function.
4. Create a custom function using Deluge scripting.
5. Define the required input parameters and implement the business logic.
6. For example, develop logic to check a book's due date and determine whether its issue status should be updated.
7. Save the function and associate it with an appropriate workflow or form event.
8. Test the function by submitting or modifying sample records.
9. Verify whether the expected changes are reflected in the application.

10. Explore Zoho Catalyst as an additional pro-code platform for implementing backend functions and API integrations, where required.
11. Test the integration and verify the output to ensure that the application behaves as expected.

Result:

Thus, the pro-code extension capabilities of Zoho Creator were explored using custom functions and Zoho Catalyst. The experiment demonstrates how programming logic, automation, and backend integration can extend the functionality of a low-code application and support more advanced business requirements.